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'Let us pray'

...HH calls on all Christian faith denominations to pray for peaceful polls

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Man buries 2 children alive

By Ruth Kambita

A man, yet to be identified if seen, has buried two children alive of whom an eight year old boy has died while the other nine year old girl managed to free herself from the soil pile and survived.

The incident happened yesterday in Chizolwe Village in Lumezi District, after the siblings left home to catch mice.

The children were about 1.5 kilometres from their home when they met the unidentified man, who offered to show them a place where they could find more mice.

Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said the man began digging what appeared to be a mouse burrow using a hoe carried by the children.

"After digging a big pit, the suspect grabbed both children, threw them into it and buried them before fleeing," Mr Mweemba said.

The girl, identified as Agnes Banda, managed to free herself from the sand and ran home, where she informed villagers about the incident.

Villagers rushed to the scene and found her brother, Mathias Banda, buried. They dug him out, but he had already died.

Mr Mweemba said police visited the scene and conducted a physical inspection, which revealed suspected foul play.

The boy's body was deposited at Lumezi District Hospital mortuary, pending a post-mortem examination.

Police have launched investigations to identify and apprehend the suspect.



President Hakainde Hichilema

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Real News in Real Time

Raphael Nakacinda fined

By Alex Maboshe

The Lusaka Magistrate's Court has convicted and fined prominent politician Raphael Nakacinda K2,400 for seditious practices.

Chief Resident Magistrate

Davies Chibwili ordered the fine to be paid immediately, saying that, if unpaid, Mr Nakachinda will serve three months' simple imprisonment in default.

Mr Nakachinda, Secretary-General of a faction of the op-

position Patriotic Front, was charged under Section 57 as read with Section 60(1)(e) of the Penal Code, Chapter 87.

The offence related to remarks he allegedly made on 26 September 2024 on the KANELE 97.7 FM Facebook page.

Prosecutors said he claimed President Hakainde Hichilema had directed the Drug Enforcement Commission, the Anti-Corruption Commission and the Zambia Police Service to raid the Lusaka home of former president Edgar Lungu in Chifwema, and urged PF members to camp at the residence.

Mr Nakachinda was arrested in early October 2024, detained for nine days and later granted K15,000 bail with two sureties.

He pleaded not guilty. During the trial, witnesses from the three agencies testified no Presidential directive was issued and that they operate independently.

The court had previously found there was a case to answer and placed Mr Nakachinda on his defence. Judgment was deferred from July 2026 and delivered on 7 August 2026.

Memory Lungu: driving beyond gender

By Ruth Kambita

For a 28-year-old Memory Lungu, driving a heavy truck at Zambeef Products PLC is more than a job, it is the fulfillment of a childhood dream.

Growing up in Kabwe, Lungu admired people behind the wheel and imagined herself becoming a driver one day.

She attended Broadway Primary School before proceeding to Mukonchi Secondary School, both in Kabwe.

After completing her education, she trained at ITC to pursue her ambition. In 2023, she drove her first truck; an eight-gear, 30-tonne vehicle without fear but with a flash of a smile.

Last year in November, Lungu joined Zambeef where



Memory Lungu

she says her career is now well defined but in an industry traditionally dominated by men.

A single mother of two children, Lungu has asked her mother in Eastern Province to

take care of her children for now as she consolidates her career path towards creating a better future for her family.

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Mambwe man nabbed over UPND T-shirt

By Alex Maboshe

A 28-year-old man has been arrested in Mambwe District of Eastern Province after he allegedly confronted a mourner wearing United Party for National Development (UPND) regalia and cut the front of his shirt with a knife.

The incident occurred at about yesterday at Mumba Village in Chief Mnkhanganya's area.

Eastern Province Police Commissioner Robertson Mweemba said the victim, 51-year-old Nason Zulu, was attending a funeral when he was approached by Gideon Ngoma, who is believed to have been intoxicated.

According to Mr Mweemba, Ngoma allegedly ordered Zulu to leave the funeral because

he was wearing a UPND shirt.

Zulu tried to avoid confrontation, but the situation escalated when Ngoma pulled out a knife and slashed the front of the shirt.

Other mourners intervened, disarmed the suspect and handed him over to officers at Mfuwe Cropping Police Post.

Ngoma was later transferred to Mambwe Police Station, where he remains in custody.

Police said the suspect is believed to be a supporter of the National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP).

A docket has been opened, and Ngoma is expected to appear in court on charges of alleged malicious damage, threats and defacing of political regalia.

Lumezi boy dies in house fire

By Ruth Kambita

A four-year-old boy has died after the grass-thatched house in which he was sleeping caught fire in Lumezi District of Eastern Province.

It is alleged that yesterday at around 19:00 hours, the boy's grandmother, Justina Banda, went to ask

for some salt from a neighbour as she was preparing supper leaving the fire unattended to.

Ms Banda returned shortly afterwards after noticing that the house was on fire and raised an alarm.

Members of the public rushed to the scene and managed to extinguish the fire, but the child, Lameck Banda, had already died in the inferno.

According to Eastern

Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba, police officers visited the scene and found the deceased's body extensively burnt.

He said the body was deposited at Lumezi District Hospital Mortuary, awaiting a post-mortem examination.

Mr Mweemba said police have opened an inquiry file to facilitate investigations into the incident.

ZAM demands answers over artists' arrests

By Alex Maboshe

Zambian Association of Musicians (ZAM) president Brian Kasoka Bwembya, has raised concern over the arrest of association members and called on police to be transparent about the circumstances.

It is alleged that two ZAM artists Moses Ng'andwe, popularly known as Chester MoPower, and Felix Mangani Phiri, also known as Felix Ndangeni Inshila together with comedian Winston Ngosa IDC Light Comedy were arrested in Western Province.

They were reportedly charged with conduct likely to cause a breach of the peace while attending a campaign rally for the opposition NRPUP.

In an exclusive interview with The Real Times Digital News, Mr Bwembya said

authorities have not disclosed the specific actions that allegedly led to the charge.

Mr Bwembya said ZAM is continuing efforts to obtain clearer information from the police and urged greater transparency.

"Our call for now is just that the police should be transparent enough to let the citizens and even ourselves know, because we deserve to know those are our members, so we deserve to know what it is that they're being held for.

What is the reason behind their arrest? Just like their families, obviously, deserve to know as well. They would want to know when or how soon they'll be able to reunite with them," he said.

Mr Bwembya also revealed that the three artists have been moved from Kalabo to Mongu.

‘Let us pray’

By Ruth Kambita

President Hakainde Hichilema has called on Catholics and other Christian denominations to hold prayer vigils for Zambia as the country prepares to go to the polls next week.

In a statement issued by State House communications specialist Clayson Hamasaka, Mr Hichilema described Zambia as a Christian nation not merely by constitutional declaration, but by actions, values and enduring trust in God.

He urged citizens to pray for peace, unity and stability, and for all candidates, election officials and security personnel involved in the electoral process.

"As the nation prepares for the elections, it is vital to ensure the process is not only free and fair but, above all, peaceful," the

President said.

The Head of State recently attended a national prayer gathering in Kitwe and wished every candidate God's blessings and a safe journey through the elections.

Separately, Muyaywa Kabisa, president of the Zambia Union of Government and Allied Workers, appealed to political parties to control their supporters and avoid violence that could undermine public confidence in the vote.

Speaking to journalists in Lusaka, Dr Kabisa reminded Zambians that elections produce winners and losers, and urged citizens, especially workers to turn out and exercise their democratic right.

"Peace is our identity as Zambians," he said, calling for election outcomes that unite the country and help overcome tribalism and nepotism.

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Zambia's National Carbon Registry launched



By Ruth Kambita

Zambia has today launched a National Carbon Registry, a sovereign digital platform designed to place the country among the first in Africa to deploy an integrated system for carbon asset management and international trading.

Developed by the Zambia Environmental Management Agency (ZEMA) with support from the Supporting Preparedness for Article 6 Cooperation

(SPAR6C) programme, the registry enables registration, tracking, quantification and verification of greenhouse gas emissions reductions, and issues carbon credits in line with Article 6 of the Paris Agreement.

Speaking at the launch in Lusaka, Ministry of Green Economy and Environment Permanent Secretary Douty Chibamba said the registry would help Zambia meet its climate goals and sustainable development objectives.

"We will ensure that all activities conform to the provisions of Zambia's Green Economy and Climate Change Act and the Paris Agreement, and that actions related to our carbon credits are visible and can be reviewed by members of the public," she said.

Zambia has signed Article 6 cooperative agreements with Sweden, Norway and Switzerland and is now prepared to trade credits internationally.

The first phase of the registry covers Article 6-aligned

projects; a second phase will incorporate voluntary carbon-market registrations and reporting.

ZEMA acting Director General Christopher Kanema said the agency would link the registry to Zambia's Integrated Monitoring, Reporting and Verification (IMRV) system to support NDC reporting and national greenhouse gas accounting.

"ZEMA is committed to ensuring the registry operates to the highest standards of integrity, security, transparency

and reliability," he said.

Built through South-to-South collaboration with Ghana's EPA and technical partners including the UNEP Copenhagen Climate Centre, the platform is funded by Germany's International Climate Initiative and implemented by the Global Green Growth Institute. Officials say interoperability with the UNFCCC's Centralised Accounting and Reporting Platform will prevent double issuance and strengthen public trust in Zambia's carbon credits.

Memory Lungu: driving beyond gender

From page two

The journey has not been without challenges as Lungu still meets people who underestimate women, believing that they should remain at home instead of taking on demanding careers.

"Sometimes people say you are a lady and that you are supposed to be at home, this job is tough, it is for men," she says.

However, her experiences on the road have also shown her that attitudes are changing. Some people admire her, while others are inspired to see a woman driving a heavy truck.

Lungu believes the transport industry is increasingly opening up to both men and women.

She encourages females interested in truck driving to be strong, fearless and prepared to overcome challenges.

Although driving has become her profession, Lungu still hopes to become a journalist, another dream she has not abandoned.

Zambeef Chief Executive Officer Faith Mukutu says Lungu and fellow female driver Alice were employed because of their ability, determination and ambition and not their gender.

Ms Mukutu says their presence is helping challenge outdated stereotypes and redefine what is possible for women.

"At Zambeef, talent, commitment and character not gender determine opportunities," she says.

Lungu's story demonstrates how courage and opportunity can transform a childhood dream into a career, while inspiring other women to pursue spaces once considered exclusively male.

Austin Liato dies

By Ruth Kambita

Former Cabinet Minister in the MMD government Austin Liato, who was contesting Nkeyema Parliamentary seat as an independent aspirant, has died, barely six days before the polls at the age of 60.

Mr Liato, who is on this year's ballot paper, was a veteran politician whose career in public office spanned more than two decades.

He first entered Parliament after winning Kaoma Central in the 2001 elections and served in several senior posts, including Deputy Minister of Energy; Minister for Lusaka Province; Deputy Minister of Labour and Social Security; and Minister of Labour and Social Security.

Mr Liato also represented Zambia at the Pan-African Parliament.

His long service was clouded by a high-profile corruption case in 2011 when authorities recovered K2.1 billion in cash buried on his Mwembeshi farm.

Mr Liato was convicted in 2012 and sentenced to two years' imprisonment with hard labour.

The High Court later quashed the conviction, but the Supreme Court reinstated it in 2015, finding the evidence supported the guilty verdict.

Details on the circumstances of his death, funeral arrangements by government and official statements from family, were not immediately available.

Transparent free, fair elections assured

By Linda Nyondo

The Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) has assured and pledged transparency, fairness and integrity as it conducts the 13 August general election.

ECZ chairperson Mwangala Zaloumis said the commission remains guided by impartiality and the rule of law.

"We are committed to transparency, providing free and fair elections while upholding the

law," she said, adding that the commission is working collaboratively with stakeholders to ensure a credible process.

Ms Zaloumis warned against misinformation and disinformation, describing them as threats to public trust.

"An informed stakeholder will supply accurate information. It is important to obtain correct information and preserve integrity," she said.

The chairperson expressed concern about low attendance at a recent preparedness meet-

ing for the election, noting that only seven political parties were represented, including the UPND, NRPUP and the Socialist Party.

She said the meeting was intended to allow interaction and resolution of concerns, and urged parties to participate fully in future engagements.

Issues raised at the meeting included disruptions to campaigns, cancellations, and reluctance by some staff to sign jobs.

The commission urged political parties to discipline their members and to avoid actions that contravene the law.

ECZ has reminded parties that pregnant women, older voters, and persons with disabilities including the blind must be permitted to skip queues and proceed directly to polling stations.

Polling agents have been trained to assist voters with disabilities; relatives or companions may also help where necessary.

The commission said certificates of authority to vote away from registered districts will be issued only to specific categories of voters.

It also welcomed progress in addressing rumours about ballot papers, following verification with stakeholders.

Ms Zaloumis said measures such as suspending campaigns have been taken in the public interest to protect lives and maintain peace and unity.

Wedson Nyirenda named Malawi Coach of the Month



By Benedict Tembo

Former Chipolopolo coach Wedson Nyirenda has started winning accolades in Malawi after being named the FDH Bank Premiership Coach of the Month for June after guiding his side

FCB Nyasa Big Bullets to a perfect record during the month.

According to a local publication, Wa Mpira, Nyirenda edged Enos Chatama of Ekhaya, Abbas Makawa of Civil Service United and Silver Strikers' Peter Mgangira to the monthly accolade after leading his side to victories in two league matches played during the period under review.

His 100 percent record in June set him apart from the other nominees, who each registered one win and one draw in their two matches.

Reacting to his nomination, Nyirenda thanked God it.

"We give God all the glory for the everything.

Settling down slowly but sure. Always not easy in foreign land.

Being conferred with the coach-of-the-month in my first month in the foreign land has really given me some encouragement to do more," Nyirenda said

He said it is not an easy achievement seeing how Malawian football has risen in recent years.

"I just thank my technical bench and support staff for their great working ethics which I have seen.

To my players I owe them so much for the love they have shown me already," Nyirenda said

He said the hardwork they are putting up and the

eagerness to learn.

"To the officials I have no words to suit how grateful I am for their enabling environment.

And last but most importantly, to the landlords of the game - the Nyasa Big Bullets Supporters. It is their support that has made all this possible and together we march on," Nyirenda said.

"All in all, it is yet another big lesson and learning curve in my career."

Arrows appreciate ZAF support, presents Muf 7s trophy to Air Command

By Benedict Tembo



The Red Arrows Rugby Club leadership on Wednesday visited Zambia Air Force (ZAF) Headquarters in Lusaka to present the 2026 MuF 7s Tournament trophies won recently.

The courtesy call was to appreciate support from ZAF Command and put on display the club's outstanding rugby performance.

According to ZAF media, club Chairperson Colonel BK Mwanza, accompanied by

Vice-Chairperson Colonel Josephine Nachona, officially handed over the trophies to the Chief of Training, Brigadier General Geoffrey Hambulo.

The presentation celebrated another remarkable achievement for the club, with the Red Arrows She Wolves successfully defending their MuF 7s title to become back to back champions.

While the Red Arrows men's team finished as runners up in a highly competitive tournament, Arrows She Wolves went one better.

Also present during the presentation were the Vice Chief of Training, Colonel Chiko Mukelabai, and the Director of Sport, Colonel Maureen Sililo, who congratulated the teams and commended their dedication, discipline, and

commitment to upholding the proud traditions of the Zambia Air Force through sporting excellence.

The presentation symbolised the strong support the Zambia Air Force continues to provide to sport, as Arrows Rugby Club remains committed to achieving greater success while proudly representing the Service on and off the field.

Norway call for Infantino to resign as Mexico and Argentina back president

Norway have called on Fifa president Gianni Infantino to resign following his aborted attempt to sell off stakes in the World Cup to private investors, but Mexico and Argentina have voiced their support for the 56-year-old.

Norway have gone a step further than the football associations of England, Wales, Croatia and Albania, all of whom have withdrawn support for Infantino without explicitly calling for him to resign.

"He [Infantino] does not have the institutional trust required to govern Fifa stably in the times we are in," Norwegian Football Federation (NFF) president Lise Klaveness said on Friday.

"There is no going back for Gianni Infantino. The international football cooperation is very much in trouble, and we must have a reason to get together now, and we want to ask the Fifa president to resign now.

"We will see which other countries eventually join in, if that becomes the strategy from the Uefa board. We are not going to ask for an extraordinary [Uefa board] meeting, we will ask him to resign in our dialogue with Fifa."

Klaveness, who is a qualified lawyer, went through a list of concerns that the Norwegian FA has expressed to Fifa during her four-year tenure.

Among them were questions around the awarding of tournaments, the inaugural Fifa peace prize that was awarded to US President Donald Trump in December, and the overturning of a ban for Ameri-

can forward Folarin Balogun during the recent World Cup following a phone call from Trump.

Fifa has been approached for comment.

Meanwhile, earlier on Friday the Mexican Football Federation broke ranks with its regional governing body Concacaf to come out in support of Infantino.

Concacaf, which runs football in North and Central America and the Caribbean, called for a "comprehensive reckoning" of Infantino's presidency after he aborted plans to sell off stakes in the World Cup to private investors.

However, 2026 World Cup co-hosts Mexico have backed Infantino's leadership amid widespread calls for him to resign.

"The FMF [Mexican FA] supports president Infantino's leadership in continuing to promote the development of football through institutional strengthening," a statement read.

It echoed a statement from Conmebol - South America's governing body - in saying it would reject any attempt to remove Infantino without a vote involving all 211 Fifa members.

However, Conmebol did "express its concern about the repeated unilateral actions taken without resorting to dialogue or the institutional mechanisms provided for dealing with this type of situation".

Meanwhile, the football association of 2026 World Cup runners-up Argentina praised Infantino for recognising and apologising for his "errors".

It described his decade-long tenure as Fifa president as "centred on the development of soccer worldwide and institutional strength based on a clear, stable, and transparent governance model".

Infantino is unanimously backed by the Confederation of African Football (CAF), but faces opposition from European football's governing Uefa and Concacaf.

European teams could still boycott the World Cup as Uefa said its conditions had not been met, despite Infantino's plan being aborted.

Uefa has already said it has lost confidence in Infantino, calling the Fifa Forward Enterprise (FFE) proposal a "shabby, back room, opaque deal".

The English FA has sent a letter withdrawing its support for Infantino, while Wales, Albania and Croatia are among other individual associations to have turned their back on the 56-year-old.

Concacaf described Infantino's proposal as "a symptom of leadership that has stopped putting football first", and that "this recent unilateral and egregious act of poor governance and leadership follows a pattern of missteps and similar behaviour".

However, unlike Uefa, it did not go as far as to say it had lost confidence in the Fifa president.

Before Infantino withdrew his proposal, the Asian Football Confederation (AFC) said it stood "in solidarity" with Uefa and Concacaf in opposition to the plans.

BBC